

9

MAYAWATI

54, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister (7)

Heartland Queen

Because she still retains sway over Uttar Pradesh and won 21 Lok Sabha seats despite the Congress, BSP and SP using her for target practice.

Because she won 13 of the 17 by-elections in the state last year, thumbing her nose at the Congress claims of a revival.

Because she emerged as a rallying point for non-Congress, non-BJP parties.

Because she is a law unto herself and refuses even the smallest initiatives to be on good terms with the Government at the Centre, skipping both the chief ministers' conferences on internal security and price rise convened by the prime minister.

Smart move Celebrated her birthday without the usual fanfare and released the fifth volume of her autobiography, *Blue Book*.

The other smart move No allotment of funds for statues and memorials in this budget.

The loner Lives behind an iron curtain where few have access to her private life.

BAG LADY Always carries a handbag. Even her statues have to have handbags; otherwise she asks them to be redone.

POWER TRIP Bought a Rs 70-crore Hawker Beechcraft 900 XP just before E-2009.



POWER MOVE Taken husband Swaraj Kaushal's first name as her surname as it's 'rhythmic'.

DAILY INDULGENCE Evening calls to her daughter Bansuri, 24, who is studying at Harvard.

SIPRA DAS/www.indiatodayimages.com

10

SUSHMA SWARAJ

58, Leader of Opposition (New)

The Contender

Because in a male-dominated party, she beat all the GenNext rivals to become the Leader of Opposition.

Because she was one of the prime-movers in pushing the Women's Reservation Bill through.

Because she united the Left, Samajwadi Party, and Rashtriya Janata Dal along with the BJP, on price hike.

Because she played her cards well and stayed away from organisational politics, preferring to focus on parliamentary issues.

Because her oratorical skills made her the party's star campaigner during E-2009 from the cowbelt to the far south.

Style statement Plays the *bharatiya nari* to the hilt—from the big bordered saris to the big *bindi* and *sindur* to celebrating Karva Chauth in full media glare.

The strategy Just like L.K. Advani did in the 1990s, she too is trying to groom a generation next leadership, promoting young MPs such as Nishikant Dubey, Varun Gandhi and Anurag Mathur to speak in the House.

The liberal move Criticised the Sri Ram Sene for imposing a behavioural code on women in Mangalore, saying that after all even her daughter visits pubs.

The Displaced

People who didn't make it to the Power List this time



4* LK.ADVANI 82
Former Leader of Opposition



8* NARENDRA MODI 59
Gujarat Chief Minister



10* LALU PRASAD YADAV 61
Rashtriya Janata Dal chief

*Last year's ranking